

Equation Story Match

Unit 7: Equation Detective Agency • Lesson 7-1 • EduWonderLab

UNIT 7 • LESSON 7-1 • TEACHER NOTES

Standard 6.EE.6

FORMAT Story-to-equation match

TIME 25–30 min

GROUPING Pairs

TOPIC Write Equations

STANDARD 6.EE.6

PREP LEVEL Light — print story cards and equation cards

Learning goal *I can write an equation for a situation and explain what the variable represents.*

Teacher setup

- Print one card set per pair. Students match each story to its equation.
- They identify the unknown and explain what the variable represents.
- No solving yet — focus on writing the equation.

Materials

Story cards, Equation cards, Variable meaning box, Pencil.

Differentiation & language support

- Variable meaning box: “Let ____ = ____.” (SPED)
- Sentence stem: “Let ____ represent ____.”
- ESOL: underline the unknown amount in each story.

Key vocabulary (English / Español):

Term	Español	What it means
equation	ecuación	a number sentence with an equal sign
variable	variable	a letter for an unknown number

Quick teacher check: *Ask a pair to state what the variable represents for Card 5.*

Equation Story Match

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Name: _____

Date: _____

Class: _____

Your goal: *I can write an equation for a situation and explain what the variable represents.*

What you need

Story cards, Equation cards.

How to play

1. Read a story card and find the unknown.
2. Write an equation using a variable.
3. Write what the variable represents.
4. Match it to the correct equation card.

Story Cards

Write an equation for each story. Name what the variable stands for.

1. A number plus 5 is 12.	2. Three times a number is 21.
3. A number minus 4 is 9.	4. A number divided by 2 is 6.
5. Twice a number, plus 1, is 13.	6. 7 less than a number is 10.
7. 5 more than a number is 20.	8. A number times 4 is 28.

Record your work (equation + what x means):

Explain your thinking

Explain how you decide which operation to use when writing an equation.

Sentence frame: *Let ___ represent ___, so the equation is ___.*

★ **Challenge:** Cards 1 and 7 look similar. Explain how the equations are different.

ANSWER KEY

Teacher copy — please do not distribute to students.

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Answers

1. A number plus 5 is 12. Answer: $x + 5 = 12$ (x = the number)	2. Three times a number is 21. Answer: $3x = 21$
3. A number minus 4 is 9. Answer: $x - 4 = 9$	4. A number divided by 2 is 6. Answer: $x \div 2 = 6$
5. Twice a number, plus 1, is 13. Answer: $2x + 1 = 13$	6. 7 less than a number is 10. Answer: $x - 7 = 10$
7. 5 more than a number is 20. Answer: $x + 5 = 20$	8. A number times 4 is 28. Answer: $4x = 28$

Teaching notes & look-fors

- Focus is writing equations, not solving.
- Card 6: “7 less than a number” is $x - 7$, not $7 - x$.